Syed Yaser Ahmed

Dallas, TX | (315) 480-9522 | yaser1091@gmail.com | GitHub

SUMMARY

Lead backend engineer with 10+ years building secure, high-availability Java systems with Spring Boot, RESTful microservices, and relational data models on AWS and Kubernetes. Hands-on with identity and access controls, including OAuth2/OIDC, JWT, role-based access control, and AWS IAM. Currently leads a team of 3 engineers on a 24/7 data platform serving 8 North American electricity markets while writing production code daily. Builds Claude Code skills that automate development workflows, with every AI-generated change validated through peer review and automated testing.

LANGUAGES & TECHNOLOGIES

Backend: Java (8/17/21), Spring Boot, Spring MVC, Spring Data JPA, jOOQ, RESTful APIs, Microservices, Python, Node.js, Express, TypeScript

Frontend: React, JavaScript

Databases: SQL Server, PostgreSQL, Oracle, relational data modeling, MongoDB, Redis

Security & Identity: OAuth2/OIDC, JWT, role-based access control, AWS IAM (roles, policies), secrets and credential management

Cloud & Containers: AWS (S3, EC2, EKS, IAM), Kubernetes, Docker, Argo CD (GitOps), Azure

CI/CD & Testing: Git, GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, JUnit, Mockito

Data & Messaging: Apache Iceberg, Trino, Spark, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Grafana

AI-Assisted Engineering: Claude Code (custom skills for workflow automation), Kiro

Architecture: Event-Driven Architecture, Domain-Driven Design, System Design

Certification: Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)

EXPERIENCE

PCI Energy Solutions **Richardson, TX**

Acting Development Manager **Oct 2025 – Present**

- Lead 3 engineers on a Java/Spring Boot ingestion platform that integrates 8 North American electricity markets (MISO, SPP, CAISO, ERCOT, PJM, NYISO, ISO-NE, AESO), running 24/7 against a 30–60 minute publication-to-query SLA across AWS and on-prem clusters.
- Redesigned the ingestion framework so new market integrations use one shared pattern, replacing hundreds of bespoke per-report, per-table repository integrations.
- Own the roadmap for moving market integrations off legacy relational databases onto Spark, Trino, and Apache Iceberg; delivered AESO natively on the new stack, migrated ERCOT with zero downstream downtime, and now lead the MISO migration.
- Secured credentials and API keys for integrations with 8 electricity markets and scoped each service's AWS access through IAM roles and least-privilege policies on EKS.
- Built custom Claude Code skills that automate adding new market downloaders, migrating integrations from the legacy framework to the lakehouse stack, and generating documentation; every AI-generated change passes code review and automated testing before merge.
- Mentor 3 engineers through design and code review, and hold design and code-review authority for teams outside the platform group.

Senior Software Developer **Jan 2023 – Oct 2025**

- Led the migration from PostgreSQL to an Apache Iceberg lakehouse with Spark ingestion and Trino query, removing the relational analytics bottleneck and enabling petabyte-scale analysis.
- Designed a common data model that normalizes per-market schemas for offers, prices, market results, dispatch instructions, and credit reports at real-time, hourly, and day-ahead granularity, turning each new market into an integration instead of a rewrite.
- Built Java 21 / Spring Boot REST ingestion services deployed to AWS (S3, EKS) and on-prem Kubernetes through Argo CD GitOps, using Redis, RabbitMQ, and Grafana for observability.

- Built the Java backend and Node.js/Express API for a real-time profit-and-loss analyzer for ERCOT market data; took over the React frontend and shipped features solo after the frontend contractor left, then trained a support team and handed off the product.
- Migrated the MISO analytics backend from a Redis task-runner architecture to Iceberg, Spark, and Trino, simplifying schema evolution and cutting new-feature development time.
- Tuned data access with jOOQ and Spring Data JPA across PostgreSQL and Oracle, cloud and on-prem.

Software Developer **Dec 2019 – Jan 2023**

- Joined the founding team of PCI's MISO market analytics product, building scheduled ETL pipelines across SQL Server, Oracle, and PostgreSQL, then rebuilding the backend around a Redis-driven scheduler whose runner service spawns container-based executors on Kubernetes.
- Implemented OAuth2/OIDC authentication with JWT and role-based access control for Spring Boot microservices.
- Built Spring Boot microservices on Kubernetes, with performance tuning and automated testing in JUnit and Mockito.

Cognizant Technologies **Oklahoma City, OK**

Software Engineer **2018 – 2019**

- Built HIPAA-compliant claims-processing components in Core Java on Azure (Red Hat VMs), sustaining 99.9%+ uptime for thousands of healthcare providers.
- Cut operational overhead 40% through automation and workflow optimization.

Eaton's Crouse-Hinds **Syracuse, NY**

Software Developer Co-op **2017 – 2018**

- Optimized C firmware and ASP.NET dashboards for hazard-rated industrial lighting, and implemented WirelessHART commissioning protocols.

Wipro Technologies **Pune, India**

Project Engineer **2013 – 2016**

- Built dashboard and workflow-automation tooling (Perl, shell, BMC Remedy, HP NNMi), cutting onboarding time 90%.

EDUCATION

Syracuse University — MS, Computer Engineering **2018**

Anna University — B.Tech, Information Technology **2013**